

Lab 0: Environment Gate

Duration: 25 min (self-paced, complete BEFORE Day 1 Block 1 ends)

Difficulty: Setup

Deliverable: A machine that passes every check below and shows the marker **YOU ARE READY**.

Objective

Verify your seat license, install Claude Code with the native installer, and confirm your environment is green before the first lab. Nothing in Day 1 works until this does.

***START MARKER:** You have a terminal open and can type commands.*

Step 1: Seat / License Check (5 min)

Claude Code requires one of these plans:

Plan	Claude Code included?
Pro (\$20/mo)	Yes
Max	Yes
Team Premium (\$100/seat (verify at delivery - fast-moving))	Yes
Enterprise	Yes
Team Standard (\$20/seat (verify at delivery - fast-moving))	NO - chat only
Free	NO

1. Sign in at <https://claude.ai> and check **Settings -> Plan**.
2. If you see **Team Standard**, stop and contact your training coordinator - you cannot run any lab on that tier.
3. Note the exact email/identity you will sign in with. Use the SAME identity in Claude Code.

Expected output marker: Your plan page shows Pro, Max, Team Premium, or Enterprise.

Step 2: Install Claude Code - Native Installer (10 min)

Claude Code no longer requires Node.js or npm. The npm install path was deprecated in January 2026. Use the native installer for your OS. Windows runs natively - no WSL required.

macOS / Linux:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

or Homebrew:

```
brew install claude-code
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
winget install Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

Linux package managers: `apt`, `dnf`, and `apk` packages are also available - see the install docs at code.claude.com.

Verify:

```
claude --version
```

Expected output marker: A version number of 2.1.x or higher (course was built against v2.1.210). If you see `command not found`, close and reopen your terminal so PATH updates take effect.

Step 3: Git + VS Code Check (3 min)

```
git --version
```

Expected: `git version 2.x.x`

```
code --version
```

Expected: A VS Code version number. (VS Code is optional but recommended - the extension bundles the CLI. Terminal-only is fully supported.)

For the lab sample project only (not for Claude Code itself):

```
node -v
```

Expected: `v18.x` or higher. The Day 1 build project uses Node/Express. If Node is missing, install the LTS from nodejs.org.

Step 4: Clone the Sample Repo (2 min)

```
git clone <SAMPLE_REPO_URL_PROVIDED_BY_INSTRUCTOR> claude-training-sample
cd claude-training-sample
ls
```

Expected output marker: A file listing including `README.md`. If no sample repo URL was provided yet, create a placeholder folder instead: `mkdir claude-training-sample && cd claude-training-sample && git init`.

Step 5: First Launch + /doctor Green (5 min)

```
claude
```

1. Complete the sign-in flow **with the identity from Step 1**.
2. When the prompt appears, run:

```
/doctor
```

Expected output marker: All checks green. The July 2026 `/doctor` runs a full diagnostic and can auto-fix common problems - if anything shows yellow/red, press `f` to auto-fix, then re-run `/doctor`.

3. Confirm the default model:

```
/model
```

Expected output marker: **Sonnet 5** shown as the current/default model.

4. Exit for now:

```
exit
```

FINISH MARKER - YOU ARE READY

If every box below is checked, you are ready for Lab 1A:

- ☐ Plan is Pro / Max / Team Premium / Enterprise (NOT Team Standard)
- ☐ `claude --version` returns 2.1.x+
- ☐ `git --version` works
- ☐ Node 18+ present (for the lab project)
- ☐ Sample repo cloned (or placeholder folder created)
- ☐ `/doctor` all green
- ☐ `/model` shows Sonnet 5

YOU ARE READY.

If Stuck

Problem	Recovery
<code>claude: command not found</code> after install	Close and reopen the terminal; on Windows, sign out/in or check PATH in System Settings
Sign-in loop / wrong account	Run <code>claude /logout</code> , then <code>claude</code> and use the Step 1 identity
<code>/doctor</code> shows red items	Press <code>f</code> for auto-fix; if still red, screenshot and post in the class channel
Corporate proxy blocks install	Ask IT to allow <code>claude.ai</code> and <code>code.claude.com</code> , or use the offline installer from your coordinator
Team Standard seat	Escalate to coordinator TODAY - seats take time to upgrade

Debrief Questions

1. Which plan tiers include Claude Code - and which Team tier does not?
2. Why does the native installer matter compared to the old npm path?
3. What does `/doctor`'s auto-fix (press `f`) actually change on your machine?